



THE HISTORY PORTAL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

EDITION 2026.1

FROM DEMOCRACY TO DICTATORSHIP: HOW DID HITLER DESTROY THE WEIMAR REPUBLIC?

*Paper 3: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918-39 - Key
Topic 2: Hitler's Rise to Power, 1919-33*

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Grade	9-1 GCSE Grading Scale		
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT2.1: The Early Development of the Nazi Party, 1919–1922 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL JUNE 2024 (Q1 INFERENCE)			
L2: KT2.2: The Munich Putsch and the Lean Years, 1923–1929 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL JUNE 2023 (Q2 CAUSATION)			
L3: KT2.3: The Growth of Nazi Support, 1929–1932 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2021 (Q3A UTILITY)			
L4: KT2.4: How Hitler Became Chancellor, 1932–1933 OFFICIAL EXAM SERIES: EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 (Q3B-D INTERPRETATIONS)			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT2.1: The Early Development of the Nazi Party, 1919–1922

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the 25-Point Programme and explain how it was designed to appeal to multiple different groups in German society.
- ☐ Analyse the methods Adolf Hitler used to take total control of the party, including his public speaking, party restructuring, and early propaganda.
- ☐ Evaluate the role and impact of the SA (Sturmabteilung), explaining how political violence became a core tactic of the early Nazi Party.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was the Spartacist Uprising (1919)?

Who led the Spartacist Uprising?

Who were the Freikorps?

What was the Kapp Putsch (1920)?

How did the government defeat the Kapp Putsch?

How much were the reparations set at?

What was the War Guilt Clause?

What was Article 48?

What was the 'stab in the back' myth?

What is a 'republic'?

Vocabulary Check

The Odd One Out: Circle ONE term that does not belong with the others. Explain your reasoning: What historical connection links the other terms, and why is your chosen term different?

DAP (German Workers' Party) | NSDAP (National Socialist German Workers' Party) | 25-Point Programme | Nationalism | Socialism | SA (Sturmabteilung) | Stosstrupp (Shock Troop) | Völkischer Beobachter

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why did the Nazi Party appeal to people in the early 1920s?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the provided narrative: 1) Hitler joined the DAP in 1919 BUT... 2) The DAP changed its name to NSDAP in 1920 BECAUSE... 3) The SA was formed in 1921 SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Write a short paragraph (approx. 75-100 words) describing the early development of the Nazi Party, ensuring you use at least FIVE of the following keywords: DAP, NSDAP, 25-Point Programme, Nationalism, Socialism, SA, Stosstrupp, Völkischer Beobachter.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain the causal link between Hitler's leadership and the rapid growth and radicalisation of the Nazi Party between 1919 and 1922. How did his actions directly contribute to these outcomes?

Counter-Factual History

Q5. Imagine that the **SA (Sturmabteilung) was never formed, or was quickly suppressed by authorities, during the 1919-1922 period. How might the early development of the Nazi Party have differed significantly, and what implications would this have had for its ability to gain influence?**

Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source A: Point 4 of the 25-Point Programme, published in February 1920.

"None but members of the nation may be citizens of the state. None but those of German blood... may be members of the nation. No Jew, therefore, may be a member of the nation."

Q6. 1. Give two things you can infer from Source A about the core beliefs of the Nazi Party in 1920.

(i) What I can infer:
Details in the source that tell me this:

(ii) What I can infer:
Details in the source that tell me this: EDEXCEL JUNE 2024 (Q1 INFERENCE)

[4 marks • 5 mins]

General Notes

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L2: KT2.2: The Munich Putsch and the Lean Years, 1923–1929

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the short-term and long-term causes, events, and immediate consequences of the 1923 Munich Putsch.
- ☐ Analyse how Hitler used his time in prison to write *Mein Kampf* and fundamentally change the strategy and structure of the Nazi Party.
- ☐ Evaluate why the Nazi Party struggled to win electoral support between 1924 and 1928, despite their highly effective internal reorganisation.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Why did France and Belgium invade the Ruhr in 1923?

How did German workers react to the Ruhr invasion?

What caused Hyperinflation in 1923?

Who suffered most from Hyperinflation?

Who benefitted from Hyperinflation?

Who were the Freikorps?

Who led the Spartacist Uprising?

How was the Kapp Putsch defeated?

What was Proportional Representation?

What were the military restrictions of the Treaty of Versailles?

Vocabulary Check

The Golden Sentence: Choose TWO terms from the word bank. Write ONE grammatically sophisticated, historically accurate sentence connecting them using a causal conjunction (because, although, or consequently):

**The Bavarian Triumvirate | Treason | Landsberg Prison | Mein Kampf ('My Struggle') |
Führerprinzip (The Leadership Principle) | Gauleiter | SS (Schutzstaffel) | Aryan**

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Was the Munich Putsch a total failure for Hitler?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson narrative:

- 1. Hitler's Munich Putsch failed to seize power in 1923, BUT...**
- 2. Hitler received a lenient sentence for treason BECAUSE...**
- 3. During his time in Landsberg Prison, Hitler wrote *Mein Kampf*, SO...**

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Using at least FOUR of the following keywords – *Mein Kampf*, Führerprinzip, Gauleiter, SS, Aryan, Landsberg Prison, Treason – explain how Hitler used his time in prison and the subsequent "Lean Years" to reshape the Nazi Party and its ideology.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain how the failure of the Munich Putsch and Hitler's subsequent imprisonment, despite being a setback, ultimately strengthened his position and the long-term trajectory of the Nazi Party.

The 'What If' Challenge

Q5. Imagine a counter-factual scenario where the Bavarian Triumvirate (Kahr, Lossow, Seisser) had *not* reneged on their initial agreement with Hitler during the Munich Putsch, and instead had supported his 'national revolution'. What might have been the immediate and long-term consequences for Germany, the Weimar Republic, and the rise of Nazism? Consider both political and social impacts.

Q6. 2. Explain why the Nazi Party experienced the 'Lean Years' between 1924 and 1928 .

You may use the following in your answer:

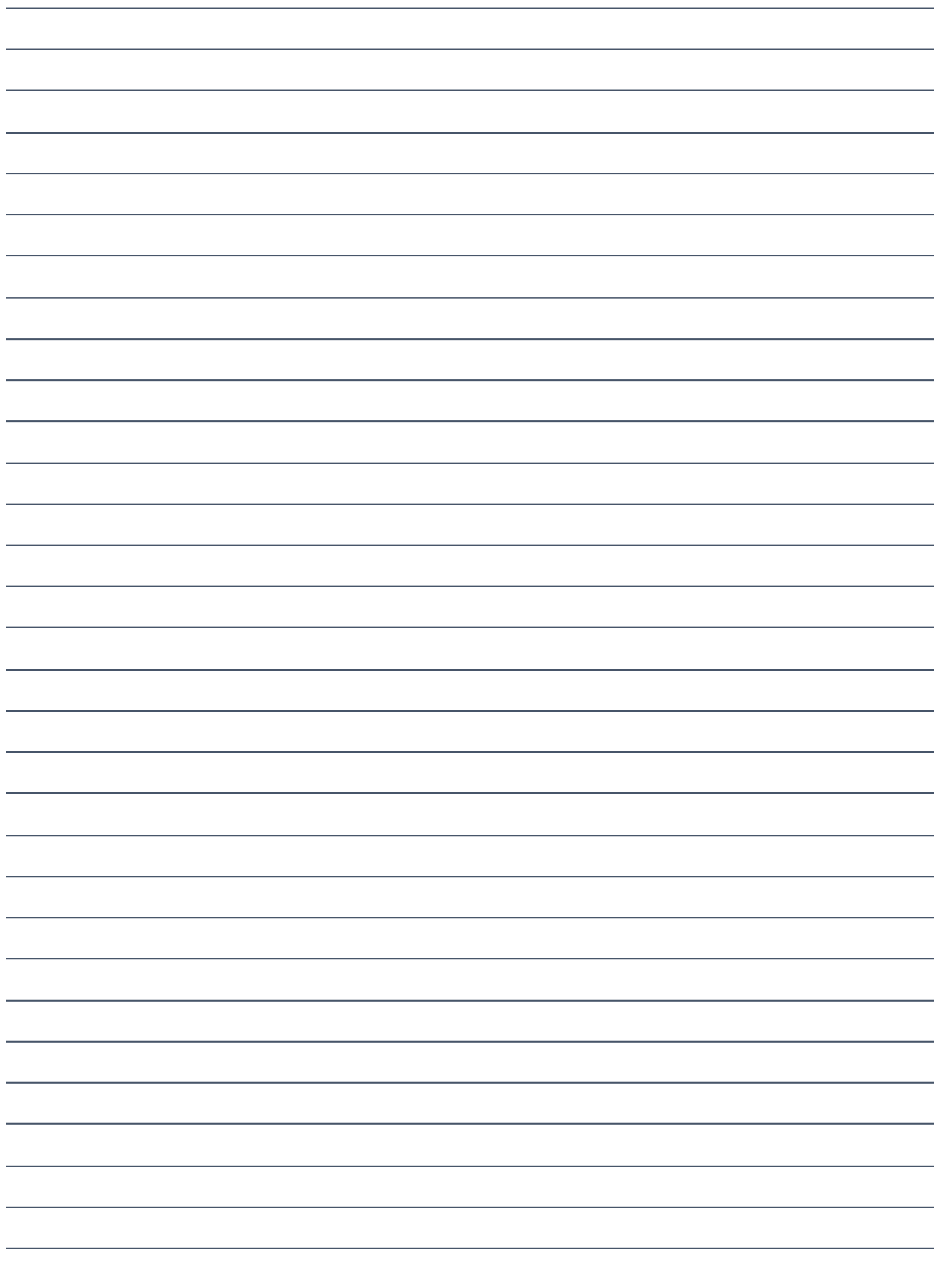
- **Stresemann's economic policies**
- **Hitler's reorganization of the party**

You must also use information of your own.

EDEXCEL JUNE 2023 (Q2 CAUSATION)

[12 marks • 15 mins]

[illegible]



General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

L3: KT2.3: The Growth of Nazi Support, 1929–1932

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise knowledge of the economic and social impacts of the 1929 Wall Street Crash on Germany.
- ☐ Analyse the political paralysis of the Weimar Republic, explaining why the collapse of Müller's coalition and Brüning's policies caused voters to flock to extremist parties.
- ☐ Evaluate the reasons for the surge in Nazi support, judging the relative importance of Hitler's personal appeal, Goebbels' propaganda, Big Business funding, and the violence of the SA.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Who became Chancellor in 1923 and helped end hyperinflation?

What new currency did Stresemann introduce in 1923?

What was the Dawes Plan (1924)?

What was the Young Plan (1929)?

What was the Locarno Pact (1925)?

Why did France invade the Ruhr in 1923?

What was passive resistance?

Who suffered most from hyperinflation?

What was the Kapp Putsch?

What was Article 231?

Vocabulary Check

Conceptual Classification: Categorise the terms from the word bank into the two historical boxes below:

The Wall Street Crash | KPD (Communist Party of Germany) | Hermann Müller | Heinrich Brüning
| Article 48 | Negative Cohesion | Rotfrontkämpferbund (Red Front Fighters' League)

Power, Governance & Warfare	Economy, Trade & Society

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why did Nazi support surge after 1929?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson narrative: 1) The Grand Coalition government under Hermann Müller collapsed BUT... 2) Heinrich Brüning increasingly relied on Article 48 BECAUSE... 3) Nazi support grew dramatically between 1929 and 1932 SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Write a short paragraph (approximately 100-150 words) explaining the political and economic crisis in Germany between 1929-1932, accurately using at least five of the following keywords: Wall Street Crash, Hermann Müller, Heinrich Brüning, Article 48, KPD, Negative Cohesion, Rotfrontkämpferbund.

Prioritising Causes

Q4. Identify and explain the *two most significant* reasons for the rapid growth of Nazi support between 1929 and 1932, justifying your choices with specific evidence from the lesson narrative.

Counter-Factual History

Q5. "If the Wall Street Crash had not occurred in October 1929, the Nazis would never have come to power." To what extent do you agree with this statement? Justify your answer with reference to the lesson narrative, considering both arguments for and against the statement.

Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source B (Contemporary Written Source):
From the diary of Luise Solmitz, a
schoolteacher in Hamburg, March 1932.

There stood Hitler in a simple black coat, looking over the crowd of 120,000 people of all classes and ages. A forest of swastika flags unfurled, the joy of this moment showed itself in roaring salute. The crowd looked up to show Hitler with touching faith, as their helper, their savior, their deliverer from unbearable distress. He is the rescuer of the scholar, the farmer, the worker, and the unemployed.

Source C (Contemporary Written Source):
From an article describing the conditions of the unemployed in Berlin, 1931.

The municipal lodging houses are filled to capacity with young, unemployed men. They completely fill the streets, standing or lying about in silence. The streets are grey, their faces are grey, and even the hair on their heads and the stubble on the cheeks of the youngest there was grey with dust and their adversity. They have lost all hope, having been completely abandoned by the Weimar government's welfare cuts.

Q6. 3a. How useful are Sources B and C for an enquiry into the growth of Nazi support, 1929–1932? EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2021 (Q3A UTILITY)

[8 marks • 10 mins]

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General Notes

[illegible]

L4: KT2.4: How Hitler Became Chancellor, 1932–1933

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Demonstrate precise chronological knowledge of the rapid succession of Weimar Chancellors between 1930 and 1933 (Brüning, von Papen, von Schleicher).
- ☐ Analyse the political scheming ("backstairs intrigue") between President Hindenburg, his inner circle, Franz von Papen, and the conservative elites.
- ☐ Evaluate why Hindenburg finally agreed to appoint Hitler as Chancellor despite his deep personal hatred for him, understanding the fatal miscalculation the elites made.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

When did Germany join the League of Nations?

What was the Kellogg-Briand Pact (1928)?

Why did the 'Golden Age' (1924-29) rely on 'dancing on a volcano'?

How did culture change during the Golden Age?

What did Stresemann introduce to fix hyperinflation?

What was the Dawes Plan?

What was the Young Plan?

What was the Locarno Pact?

Why did the French invade the Ruhr?

Who were the November Criminals?

Vocabulary Check

Spot the Deliberate Error: Read the statement below. One historical fact or vocabulary concept has been deliberately falsified. Underline the error and explain the accurate historical reality below:

**Paul von Hindenburg | The Camarilla | Franz von Papen | Kurt von Schleicher | Backstairs
Intrigue | Cabinet**

"In January 1933, President Paul von Hindenburg appointed Adolf Hitler Chancellor following a nationwide democratic election victory, rejecting all Backstairs Intrigue from Franz von Papen and the Camarilla."

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Did Hitler seize power or was it handed to him?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson:

- 1. Kurt von Schleicher became Chancellor in December 1932, BUT...**
- 2. Franz von Papen wanted to get back into power BECAUSE...**
- 3. President Hindenburg ultimately appointed Hitler as Chancellor SO...**

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Write a short paragraph (5-7 sentences) explaining how Hitler became Chancellor, making sure to use ALL the following keywords: Paul von Hindenburg, The Camarilla, Franz von Papen, Kurt von Schleicher, Backstairs Intrigue, Cabinet. You may underline or bold the keywords in your answer.

Prioritising Causes

Q4. Of the factors described in the lesson, which do you think was the *most* important in Hitler becoming Chancellor? Explain your reasoning. Then, identify one *other* important factor and explain its significance.

Counter-Factual History

Q5. Imagine that President Hindenburg had refused to meet with Franz von Papen and Hitler in early January 1933, or had simply dismissed Papen's proposals outright. What do you think would have been the most likely immediate political consequences for Germany? Consider the roles of Schleicher, the Nazi Party, and the broader political climate.

Exam Sources & Interpretations

Interpretation 1 (The Democratic Collapse View):

Hitler's rise to power was the inevitable result of the collapse of the Weimar democratic system. The Great Depression permanently paralyzed the Reichstag, forcing a reliance on Article 48 presidential emergency decrees that destroyed democratic legitimacy. By 1932, democracy was already dead, and the conservative elites had to hand power to Hitler because his party was the largest in the parliament.

Interpretation 2 (The Political Intrigue View):

Hitler's appointment as Chancellor was not inevitable, but was the direct result of secret political scheming and backstairs intrigue. The Nazi vote was actually declining by late 1932, and the party was running out of money. Hitler was only rescued because Franz von Papen, President Hindenburg, and conservative landowners made the fatal, cynical miscalculation that they could use his mass popularity to serve their own authoritarian goals.

Q6. 3b. Study Interpretations 1 and 2. They give different views about how Hitler became Chancellor in 1932–33. What is the main difference between these views?

EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 (Q3B INTERPRETATION DIFFERENCE)

[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q7. 3c. Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 give different views about how Hitler became Chancellor in 1932–33. You may use Sources B and C to help explain your answer.

EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 (Q3C INTERPRETATION WHY)

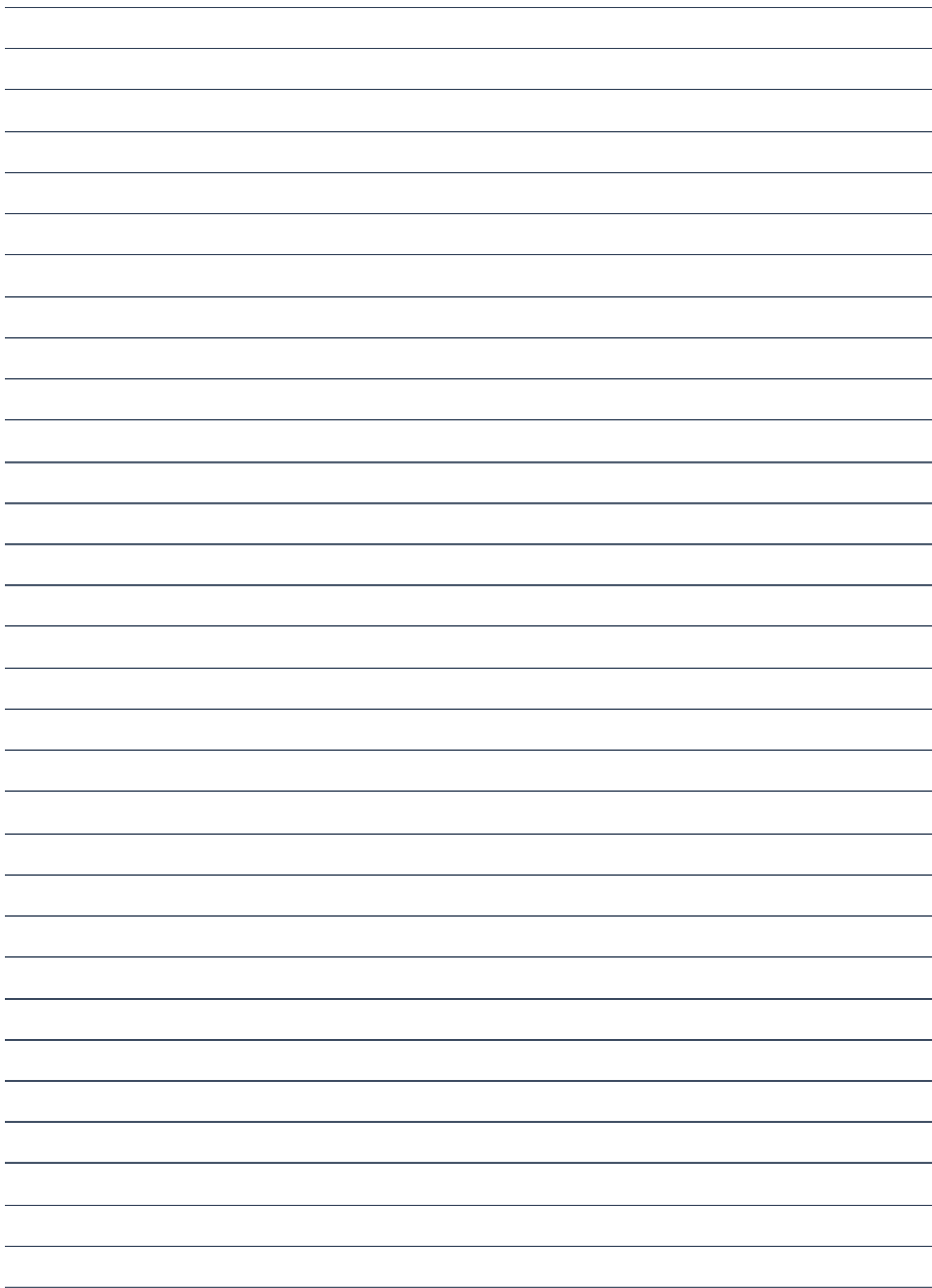
[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q8. 3d. How far do you agree with Interpretation 2 about how Hitler became Chancellor in 1932–33? Explain your answer, using both interpretations and your knowledge of the historical context.

EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 (Q3D INTERPRETATION EVALUATION)

[16 marks • 20 mins]

[illegible]





TEACHER FEEDBACK & D.I.R.T.

Mark: _____ / 16 (+4 SPaG) | Effort: 1 2 3 4 5

SPaG Self/Peer Checklist (4 Marks):

☐ Capital letters for proper nouns (e.g. Reichstag, Ebert)

☐ Historical terminology spelled accurately

☐ Punctuation separates complex clauses

What Went Well (WWW):

Even Better If (EBI):

Student D.I.R.T. Response / Correction:

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End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Paper 3: Weimar & Nazi Germany (1918–39)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)